

# Word family: **generous / generously / generosity**

**Base word:** generous

**Part of speech:** adjective

**Related forms:**

**generously** (adv.) — 慷慨地；大量地

**generosity** (n.) — 慷慨；大方

**overgenerous** (adj.) — 過分慷慨的；給得過多的

**ungenerous** (adj.) — 不大方的；不寬厚的

**Useful patterns / extensions:**

**generous person**

**generous with money / time / praise**

**generous to someone**

**generous donation**

**generous offer**

**generous portion**

**generous amount**

**generous salary / benefits**

**generous interpretation**

**generous estimate**

**generous spirit**

**an act of generosity**

**generous to a fault**

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## ## Meaning in this passage

> It showed me that he is not only imaginative, but also **generous** and big-hearted.

Here, **generous** describes Leo's **character**.

It means:

### **willing to give, share, forgive, or put other people's feelings before your own — 慷慨的；大方的；樂於與人分享和體諒別人的**

In this particular situation, Leo's cardboard bridge had been broken by a younger child. Instead of becoming angry, he responded kindly:

> “That's okay, we can build a better one.”

So **generous** here is broader than merely **giving money**. It describes a person who is **unselfish, forgiving, and willing to treat others kindly**.

**中文翻譯：**

這讓我看出，他不但富有想像力，而且也非常**大方、寬厚**，很有愛心。

For this sentence, **寬厚 / 大方** is especially natural.

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# 1. **generous person** ( 待人大方、慷慨 ) — 慷慨的；大方的

This is the core personality meaning and the one used in your passage.

### Practice 1 — original sentence

> It showed me that he is not only imaginative, but also **generous** and big-hearted.

這讓我看出，他不但富有想像力，而且也很**大方、寬厚**，很有愛心。

### Practice 2

> She is a very **generous** person who is always willing to help others.

她是個非常**慷慨大方**的人，總是願意幫助別人。

### Practice 3

> His **generous** nature makes people feel comfortable around him.

他**寬厚大方**的性格令身邊的人感到很自在。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous** = 願意給予、分享、幫助或體諒別人，而不過分計較自己利益的

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# 2. **generous with money** — 在金錢上大方

### Practice 1

> She has always been very **generous with her money**.

她在金錢方面一向很**慷慨**。

### ### Practice 2

> He is especially **generous with younger members of the family**.

他對家中年紀較小的成員特別**大方**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous with money** = 願意花錢、捐錢或給別人金錢，而不吝嗇

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# 3. **generous with time** — 樂意花時間幫助別人

**Generous** is not limited to money.

### ### Practice 1

> She is very **generous with her time**.

她很**願意花時間幫助別人**。

### ### Practice 2

> The teacher was **generous with his time** and stayed after class to help us.

那位老師很**願意付出自己的時間**，下課後留下來幫助我們。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous with your time** = 願意把自己的時間花在幫助、陪伴或支持別人上

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# 4. **generous with praise / compliments** — 不吝嗇讚美

### ### Practice 1

> Good managers should be **generous with praise** when employees do well.

員工表現良好時，優秀的經理應該**不吝嗇讚美**。

### ### Practice 2

> She is always **generous with compliments**.

她一向都很**樂意讚美別人**。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generous with praise/compliments = 樂意充分地稱讚別人，不吝於給予肯定\*\***

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# 5. **\*\*generous to someone — 對某人慷慨 / 大方\*\***

### Practice 1

> His grandparents have always been **\*\*generous to him\*\***.

他的祖父母一直都對他很**\*\*大方\*\***。

### Practice 2

> The community was extremely **\*\*generous to the family\*\*** after the accident.

意外發生後，社區的人對那個家庭非常**\*\*慷慨、熱心相助\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generous to someone = 對某人願意給予很多幫助、金錢、禮物或支持\*\***

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# 6. **\*\*generous donation — 慷慨捐款\*\***

### Practice 1

> The charity received a **\*\*generous donation\*\*** from a local business.

該慈善機構收到一家本地企業的**\*\*慷慨捐款\*\***。

### Practice 2

> Her **\*\*generous donation\*\*** helped fund the new community centre.

她的**\*\*大筆捐款\*\***幫助資助了新的社區中心。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generous donation = 金額較大、顯示捐款者十分大方的捐款\*\***

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# 7. **\*\*generous gift — 大方的禮物；價值可觀的禮物\*\***

### Practice 1

> Thank you for such a **generous gift**.

謝謝你送我這麼**大方 / 貴重的禮物**。

#### ### Practice 2

> They gave the couple a very **generous wedding gift**.

他們送給那對新人一份非常**大方的結婚禮物**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous gift = 價值、數量或心意超出一般程度的禮物**

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# 8. **generous offer** — 優厚的條件 / 慷慨的提議

Here **generous** often means that what is offered is **more favourable than expected**.

#### ### Practice 1

> The company made him a **generous offer**.

公司向他提出了很**優厚的條件**。

#### ### Practice 2

> That was a very **generous offer**, but she decided not to accept it.

那是一個很**優厚的提議**，但她決定不接受。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous offer = 給予對方較多利益、金錢或好處的優厚提議**

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# 9. **generous salary / benefits** — 優厚的薪酬 / 福利

#### ### Practice 1

> The position comes with a **generous salary**.

這個職位提供**優厚薪酬**。

#### ### Practice 2

> Employees receive a **generous benefits package**.

員工可獲得**優厚的福利待遇**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous salary/benefits = 金額、待遇或福利比一般水平高的**

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# 10. **generous portion / serving — 份量很大的**

A very common extension.

### Practice 1

> The restaurant serves **generous portions**.

這間餐廳的食物**份量很足**。

### Practice 2

> She gave me a **generous serving of rice**.

她給了我**很大一份飯**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous portion/serving = 份量比一般預期更多、更充足的**

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# 11. **a generous amount — 相當多的量；充足的量**

### Practice 1

> Add a **generous amount of olive oil**.

加入**相當多 / 充足份量的橄欖油**。

### Practice 2

> The room receives a **generous amount of natural light**.

這個房間有**充足的自然光**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**\*\*a generous amount = 數量相當多、充足，通常多於最低需要\*\***

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# 12. **\*\*generous space / dimensions — 寬敞的；空間充裕的\*\***

### Practice 1

> The apartment has **\*\*generous living space\*\***.

這個單位有**\*\*寬敞的生活空間\*\***。

### Practice 2

> The room is of **\*\*generous proportions\*\***.

這個房間的**\*\*空間相當寬敞\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generous space/proportions = 空間、尺寸或面積相當大而充裕的\*\***

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# 13. **\*\*generous estimate — 寬鬆的估計；偏高 / 偏有利的估計\*\***

Here, **\*\*generous\*\*** means allowing more than a strict calculation would.

### Practice 1

> Even by a **\*\*generous estimate\*\***, fewer than half the students attended.

即使採用**\*\*較寬鬆的估計\*\***，出席的學生仍不足一半。

### Practice 2

> Calling the project “almost complete” would be a **\*\*generous estimate\*\***.

說這個項目「差不多完成」已經算是**\*\*很寬鬆的估計\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generous estimate = 相比嚴格或保守計算，給予較高、較寬鬆結果的估計\*\***

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# 14. **\*\*generous interpretation — 寬厚 / 有利的解讀\*\***

#### ### Practice 1

> A **generous interpretation** of his comment would be that he was trying to help.

如果作**較寬厚的理解**，他的話可能只是想幫忙。

#### ### Practice 2

> Even under the most **generous interpretation**, the explanation is difficult to accept.

即使用最**寬鬆、有利的方式解讀**，這個解釋仍很難令人接受。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous interpretation** = 對某人的言行採取較寬容、較有利的理解方式

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# 15. **generous spirit / heart** — 慷慨寬厚的心

#### ### Practice 1

> She is admired for her **generous spirit**.

大家都欣賞她**慷慨寬厚的心胸**。

#### ### Practice 2

> His response showed what a **generous heart** he had.

他的反應顯示出他有一顆多麼**寬厚善良的心**。

**MCQ-ready definition:**

**generous spirit/heart** = 樂於分享、體諒、幫助及善待他人的性格

This is very close to the sense used for Leo.

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# 16. **generous to a fault** — 慷慨得有點過頭

An established expression.

#### ### Practice 1

> He's **generous to a fault** and sometimes gives away more than he can afford.

他\*\*慷慨得有點過頭\*\*，有時會送出超過自己負擔得起的東西。

#### ### Practice 2

> She is \*\*generous to a fault\*\* with her time.

她在付出時間方面\*\*大方得幾乎過了頭\*\*。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*generous to a fault = 太過慷慨，以至有時對自己造成不利\*\*

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# 17. \*\*generously (慷慨地) — 大方地；慷慨地\*\*

#### ### Practice 1

> She \*\*generously offered\*\* to pay for dinner.

她很\*\*大方地主動提出\*\*請大家吃晚飯。

#### ### Practice 2

> Local residents \*\*generously donated\*\* food and clothing.

當地居民\*\*慷慨地捐出\*\*食物和衣物。

\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\*

\*\*generously = 以願意多給、多分享或多幫助的方式\*\*

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# 18. \*\*generously (大量地) — 大量地；充足地\*\*

This corresponds to the quantity sense of \*\*generous\*\*.

#### ### Practice 1

> Spread the butter \*\*generously\*\* over the bread.

在麵包上\*\*多塗一些 / 厚厚地塗上\*\*牛油。

#### ### Practice 2

> Season the vegetables \*\*generously\*\* with pepper.

在蔬菜上\*\*充分地\*\*加胡椒調味。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generously = 以較大的份量或比最低需要更多的程度\*\***

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# 19. **\*\*generosity (慷慨；大方) — 慷慨；寬厚\*\***

### Practice 1

> Everyone was touched by her **\*\*generosity\*\***.

大家都被她的**\*\*慷慨\*\***感動。

### Practice 2

> His **\*\*generosity\*\*** extends beyond money; he also gives people his time.

他的**\*\*慷慨\*\***不只表現在金錢上，他也很願意花時間陪伴別人。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*generosity = 樂於給予、分享、幫助或寬待別人的品格\*\***

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# 20. **\*\*an act of generosity — 慷慨之舉\*\***

### Practice 1

> Paying for the family's meal was an unexpected **\*\*act of generosity\*\***.

替那個家庭付飯錢是一個意想不到的**\*\*慷慨之舉\*\***。

### Practice 2

> His response to the younger child was a small **\*\*act of generosity\*\***.

他對那個年幼孩子的反應是一個小小的**\*\*寬厚之舉\*\***。

**\*\*MCQ-ready definition:\*\***

**\*\*an act of generosity = 一個顯示某人慷慨、大方或體諒別人的行為\*\***

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# Important distinction 1: **\*\*generous vs kind\*\***

These overlap, but they are not identical.

### \*\*kind\*\*

broadly means considerate, caring, and helpful.

> She is very \*\*kind\*\*.

她很善良。

### \*\*generous\*\*

emphasizes \*\*giving freely\*\*—money, time, help, praise, forgiveness, or consideration.

> She is very \*\*generous with her time\*\*.

她很願意花時間幫助別人。

In your passage Leo is \*\*both\*\*:

\* \*\*kind\*\* → 善良

\* \*\*generous\*\* → 大方、寬厚，不計較

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# Important distinction 2: \*\*generous vs big-hearted\*\*

Very close in your passage.

### \*\*generous\*\*

can describe both:

\* character

\* amounts/offers/portions

### \*\*big-hearted\*\*

almost always describes \*\*character\*\*:

= kind, warm, forgiving, generous

So:

> a \*\*generous portion\*\* 

but:

> a **big-hearted portion** ❌

In your passage, **generous and big-hearted** reinforce Leo's warm, unselfish personality.

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# Important distinction 3: **generous vs giving**

### **generous**

standard and broad.

### **giving**

describes a person who readily gives time, affection, help, etc.

> She's a very **giving person**.

她是個很樂於付出的人。

**Giving** is mainly about character; **generous** has many additional quantity and evaluation senses.

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# Important distinction 4: **generous vs charitable**

### **generous**

broad: giving freely to anyone.

### **charitable**

can mean:

1. giving to people in need / charities
2. figuratively, judging someone kindly

> a **charitable donation**

慈善捐款

> a **charitable interpretation**

## 寬厚的解讀

So **charitable** overlaps with **generous**, but is narrower in several contexts.

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# Important distinction 5: **generous** vs **selfless**

### **generous**

willing to give/share.

### **selfless**

puts others' needs ahead of one's own, sometimes at personal cost.

> a **generous** person

> 大方的人

> a **selfless** act

> 無私的行為

**Selfless** is usually stronger.

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# Important distinction 6: **generous** vs **lavish**

### **generous**

more than enough; pleasantly abundant.

> a **generous** meal

份量充足的一餐

### **lavish**

very abundant, expensive, or extravagant.

> a **lavish** banquet

豪華盛宴

So **lavish** is usually much stronger and may imply extravagance.

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# Important distinction 7: **generous vs large**

Compare:

> a **large portion**

大份量

> a **generous portion**

份量很足

**Large** objectively describes size.

**Generous** adds the idea that **someone has provided more than the minimum or expected amount**.

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# Important distinction 8: **generous vs plenty of**

### **generous amount**

describes the amount as ample.

> a **generous amount of sauce**

很足的醬汁份量

### **plenty of**

means enough or more than enough.

> There is **plenty of sauce**.

有很多 / 足夠的醬汁。

Same general idea, different grammar.

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# Important distinction 9: **generous offer vs good offer**

### **good offer**

generally attractive.

### \*\*generous offer\*\*

specifically suggests the person making it is offering \*\*more money, benefits, or favourable terms than expected\*\*.

So \*\*generous\*\* highlights the favourable quantity/terms.

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# Important distinction 10: \*\*generous estimate vs accurate estimate\*\*

A \*\*generous estimate\*\* is not necessarily the most accurate.

It deliberately or naturally allows a favourable margin.

> A \*\*generous estimate\*\* would put attendance at 100.

較寬鬆地估計，出席人數可算作 100。

So \*\*generous\*\* here means \*\*lenient / favourable\*\*, not “kind-hearted.”

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# Important distinction 11: \*\*generous with vs generous to\*\*

### \*\*generous with + thing\*\*

focuses on what is given.

> generous \*\*with money\*\*

在金錢上大方

> generous \*\*with praise\*\*

不吝嗇讚美

### \*\*generous to + person\*\*

focuses on the recipient.

> generous \*\*to his children\*\*

對孩子很大方

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# Important distinction 12: **generous vs forgiving**

This is especially relevant to Leo.

### **forgiving**

specifically means not remaining angry after someone does something wrong.

### **generous**

can include a forgiving attitude, but is broader.

Leo's response:

> "That's okay, we can build a better one."

is **forgiving**, but it also demonstrates a broader **generous spirit** because he does not selfishly focus on his own loss.

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# Important distinction 13: **generosity vs generosity of spirit**

### **generosity**

can refer simply to giving money or resources.

### **generosity of spirit**

specifically emphasizes a **warm, forgiving, open-hearted personality**.

> His reaction showed real **generosity of spirit**.

他的反應顯示出真正的**寬厚胸襟**。

This phrase is particularly close to the passage sense.

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# Family-extension note

**Generous** has two especially important modern semantic branches:

#### ### 1. \*\*character / behaviour\*\*

Someone freely gives:

- \* money
- \* time
- \* help
- \* praise
- \* sympathy
- \* forgiveness

This produces meanings such as:

- \* generous person
- \* generous with time
- \* generous spirit

#### ### 2. \*\*more than the minimum / expected amount\*\*

Something is ample or favourable:

- \* generous portion
- \* generous salary
- \* generous offer
- \* generous estimate

These branches are related through the core idea:

#### ### \*\*giving or allowing more rather than less\*\*

So we should not treat \*\*generous salary\*\*, \*\*generous portion\*\*, and \*\*generous offer\*\* as completely unrelated meanings. They share the semantic idea of \*\*more than minimally required or normally expected\*\*.

At the same time, the passage sense is clearly the \*\*human-character branch\*\*, not the quantity sense.

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#### # Master comparison

| Form / expression       | Traditional Chinese | Core idea           |  |
|-------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|--|
| -----                   | -----               | -----               |  |
| **generous person**     | 慷慨的；大方的；寬厚的         | freely gives/shares |  |
| **generous with money** | 在金錢上大方              | gives money freely  |  |

|                             |           |                             |  |
|-----------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------|--|
| **generous with time**      | 樂意付出時間    | gives time freely           |  |
| **generous with praise**    | 不吝嗇讚美     | gives praise freely         |  |
| **generous to someone**     | 對某人大方     | treats recipient generously |  |
| **generous donation**       | 慷慨 / 大筆捐款 | substantial giving          |  |
| **generous gift**           | 大方的禮物     | more than expected          |  |
| **generous offer**          | 優厚提議      | favourable terms            |  |
| **generous salary**         | 優厚薪酬      | relatively high pay         |  |
| **generous benefits**       | 優厚福利      | ample benefits              |  |
| **generous portion**        | 份量充足      | large serving               |  |
| **generous amount**         | 相當多的量     | ample quantity              |  |
| **generous space**          | 寬敞的空間     | ample size                  |  |
| **generous estimate**       | 寬鬆估計      | favourable/high estimate    |  |
| **generous interpretation** | 寬厚 / 有利解讀 | charitable reading          |  |
| **generous spirit**         | 慷慨寬厚的心    | open-hearted character      |  |
| **generous to a fault**     | 慷慨得過了頭    | excessively generous        |  |
| **generously**              | 慷慨地       | freely giving               |  |
| **generously** (quantity)   | 大量地 ; 充足地 | ample amount                |  |
| **generosity**              | 慷慨 ; 寬厚   | quality of giving           |  |
| **act of generosity**       | 慷慨 / 寬厚之舉 | generous action             |  |

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### For your original sentence

> It showed me that he is not only imaginative, but also \*\*generous\*\* and big-hearted.

Here:

### \*\*generous = 大方的 ; 寬厚的 ; 不自私並願意體諒別人的\*\*

The important context is that another child has just \*\*broken something Leo spent a long time making\*\*.

Leo could reasonably have become angry or upset.

Instead, he says:

> "That's okay, we can build a better one."

That is why \*\*generous\*\* here does \*\*not\*\* mean:

\* giving a large amount of money,

\* giving a large portion of food,

\* offering a high salary.

It describes his \*\*generosity of spirit\*\*:

### \*\*he responds to another person's mistake with kindness rather than selfish anger or blame.\*\*

A very natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這讓我看岀，他不但富有想像力，而且也很\*\*大方、寬厚\*\*，很有愛心。

So for this passage, \*\*寬厚\*\* captures an especially important part of the meaning.